UPSC Syllabus on One Page

Civil Services Exam: Prelims + Mains, mapped to 6 core subjects. Works for APPSC & TGPSC Group 1.

Decode UPSC
with Mounika

STAGE 1 · PRELIMS

Screening only

GS Paper I · 100 Qs · 200 marks · 2 hrs · decides the cut-off

- Current events of national & international importance
- History of India & Indian National Movement
- Indian & World Geography: physical, social, economic
- Indian Polity & Governance: Constitution, Panchayati Raj, public policy, rights issues
- Economic & Social Development: sustainability, poverty, inclusion, demographics, social sector
- Environmental ecology, biodiversity & climate change (general)
- General Science

GS Paper II (CSAT) · 80 Qs · 200 marks · **qualifying, 33%**

Comprehension · communication · reasoning · decision making · mental ability · Class 10 maths & data interpretation. Wrong answer = −⅓.

STAGE 2 · MAINS

Counts for rank

- **Paper A** Indian language & **Paper B** English · 300 each · *qualifying*
- **Essay** · 250
- **GS I** · 250 · Heritage & culture, history & geography of the world, society
- **GS II** · 250 · Governance, Constitution, polity, social justice, international relations
- **GS III** · 250 · Technology, economy, biodiversity, environment, security, disaster management
- **GS IV** · 250 · Ethics, integrity & aptitude
- **Optional I & II** · 250 each · one subject of your choice

STAGE 3 · INTERVIEW

275 marks

Mains 1,750 + **Interview 275** = **Rank out of 2,025**

THE 6 CORE SUBJECTS: WHERE EACH ONE IS TESTED

CORE SUBJECT	PRELIMS	MAINS	GROUP 1 CORE	STUDY IT IN TWO LAYERS
Polity & Governance	✓	GS II	✓	Articles & facts → how institutions work, debates
History & Culture	✓	GS I	✓	Events & people → causes, impact, significance
Geography	✓	GS I	✓	Maps & features → processes, resources, distribution
Economy	✓	GS III	✓	Terms & schemes → growth, inclusion, policy trade-offs
Environment & Ecology	✓	GS III	✓	Species, parks, treaties → conservation & climate policy
Science & Technology	✓	GS III	✓	Basics & new tech → applications & ethics of technology
Current affairs	Runs through every paper. Tag each news item to one of the subjects above.			
+ State layer (Group 1)	State history & culture · Telangana movement & state formation · AP Reorganisation Act 2014 issues · state economy, budget & schemes			

MAINS-ONLY ADDITIONS

Society	Social justice & IR	Security & disasters	Ethics	Essay + Optional
GS I	GS II	GS III	GS IV	750 marks

USE THIS PAGE EVERY DAY

1. Keep it on your desk
This is your filter for every book, video and note.

2. Locate before you study
Find the topic here first. Not here? Ask why you're reading it.

3. Tag the news
Court ruling → GS II. RBI policy → GS III. News is the syllabus, this week.

Summarised from the UPSC CSE notification. Always check the latest notification at upsc.gov.in, psc.ap.gov.in and websitenew.tgpsc.gov.in.

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